

FUTURE OF OLYMPIC ESPORTS GAMES HITS A ROADBLOCK

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The future of Olympic Esports Games hit another roadblock after the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the Saudi Olympic and Paralympic Committee (SOPC) parted ways on the initiative. It marks the end of a year-long partnership that could have led to the first global esports event under the Olympic banner.

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Both parties, however, reiterated their intent to continue pursuing separate esports ambitions.

“The IOC will now develop a new approach to the Olympic Esports Games, taking feedback from its ‘Pause and Reflect’ process into account,” the committee said in a statement. “This will allow the Games to better align with the long-term ambitions of the Olympic Movement and ensure wider participation across countries.”

The move indicates a significant pivot for IOC in its plans to integrate esports within the Olympic framework. The earlier partnership with Saudi Arabia was seen as a move to utilise the Kingdom’s rapid growth in gaming infrastructure and global esports tournaments, which saw it host consecutive Esports World Cups.

But an end to the alliance will now have the IOC rework its structure of the Olympic Esports Games, which

could potentially lead to decentralising its organisation to bring in more countries into the scheme of things in the esports ecosystem.

BMIC 2025: TRUE RIPPERS IMPRESS; KRAFTON INTRODUCES 2026 ROADMAP

Indian Gaming team, True Rippers, emerged as the runner-up while South Korea’s TEAM DRX was crowned champion at the BattleGrounds Mobile India International Cup (BMIC) 2025 — a crucial international LAN event held in New Delhi.

The champion bagged INR 30 lakh, along with a direct qualification to the Global Championship 2025, while the runner-up got INR 15 lakh, a the second runner-up — CAG Osaka — took home INR 10 lakh.

Among individual performers, DRXHYUNBIN was adjudged the MVP, getting a prize money of INR 2.5 lakh, while DRXQxzzz won the IGL (In-game leader) title and a cash prize of INR 1.25 lakh. M4xHERo won INR 1 lakh for being the best clutch player.

The event – BMIC — saw KRAFTON, the publisher of BattleGrounds Mobile India, reveal its 2026 Esports Roadmap that included expanded versions of its key esports events in India: BGIS, BMPS, BMSD, and BMIC.

These events will take place in various cities, while Mumbai will host the inaugural edition of KRAFTON India Awards next year. These awards aim to identify and empower India’s burgeoning gaming talent.